

STRATEGY AND ADDITIONAL FEATURES TO INCREASE CIS PDAM SURABAYA BRAND AWARENESS

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Abstract

Perusahaan Daerah Air Minum (PDAM) launched a mobile application (Customer Information System) CIS in 2022, overall the CIS application is good enough to serve customers, but there are several problems faced by CIS as an application, such as problems with the application system, lack of marketing to raise CIS brand awareness, and problems with features that are lacking and not easy to understand. To solve the problems faced by CIS, there are several solutions that CIS can run to overcome the problems that occur such as, CIS can add features needed by customers by conducting application surveys and responding to customer responses to application reviews on Google Playstore or Appstore, system problems that occur in the CIS application, CIS can adopt microservices architecture into the application system, by adopting microservices architecture the CIS system will be more stable and customers will be more satisfied with the services received. To increase CIS brand awareness, CIS can use local Surabaya influencers to introduce the CIS application, the advantages of the CIS application, and the benefits that users will get after using the CIS application. CIS can also provide discounts for customers who use e-wallet payment methods that have collaborated with CIS, CIS can also provide discounts for new users and specifically for users who regularly pay water bills on time through CIS.

Keywords: *Microservices Architecture, Influencer, Brand Awareness*

Introduction

PDAM Surya Sembada is a regionally-owned enterprise that supplies clean water services within Surabaya. The company's ambition is to establish itself as a prominent modern drinking water provider. In 2022, PDAM Surabaya launched the Customer Information System (CIS) application to enhance customer service through digital advancements. This application facilitates various functions, including recording water meter readings, lodging service complaints, making online payments, registering for new connections, and more, all aimed at simplifying the user experience with PDAM services. Despite being operational for



over eight years, the CIS application encounters several obstacles that impede its widespread use. Recent data indicate that only 9.22% of its 620,000 customers actively engage with the CIS application. PDAM Surabaya has set a goal to boost active CIS users by 90% over the next year in Surabaya. Between September 23 and 29, 2024, a promotional campaign led by the CIS Ambassador successfully increased application downloads to 272,122 devices. Nevertheless, the ratio of active users remains disappointingly low.

Several major issues impede the expansion of the CIS application, including insufficient brand recognition among Surabaya's residents, limited promotion through social media, and various technical difficulties within the application, such as problems with checking water meter readings, ordering tank water, processing bill payments, and registration issues, along with a user interface that some users find complicated and difficult to navigate. Here, we will explore potential solutions or innovations to address these challenges. To enhance brand recognition and promote more effectively on social media, we suggest that PDAM partner with local influencers. These influencers can help engage customers aged 25 and older who are active on platforms like Instagram and TikTok. Additionally, for customers aged 40 and above, PDAM could offer discounts as incentives for both new users and those who consistently pay their bills punctually. Moreover, to resolve the technical issues within the application, we propose adopting a microservices architecture approach. Utilizing this method would allow the application's features to be segmented into distinct components, making processes quicker, more adaptable, and minimizing downtime during updates. Consequently, any updates made to one feature would not disrupt the functionality of others.

Discussion

1. Marketing Strategy

CIS can conduct promotions aimed at increasing brand awareness among the Surabaya community, with increased brand awareness among the Surabaya community, it will make CIS more familiar and more Surabaya people will want to try using the CIS application. For users in the 25-40 age group, CIS can use local influencers who are well known in the Surabaya community such as Stanley Hao as a promotional medium. Influencers can do promotion by creating content in the form of informative, unique and interesting short videos aimed at introducing the CIS application and its features through social media that are widely used by the public such as Tiktok, Facebook, and Instagram. For its own promotion method,



CIS can adopt the soft selling marketing method by emphasizing the reasons why people need this application and how this application can make it easier for people to solve problems related to PDAM, where the benefits of the application and its implementation in people's daily lives can be explained. This will make people feel more motivated to use the CIS application. This marketing method can be said to be quite effective for today because this method involves the emotions of the community and has an effect for a long period of time. For users aged 40 and above, CIS can offer discounts for new users and users who regularly pay water bills on time through the CIS application.

Furthermore, CIS can collaborate with e-wallets and provide discount promos for users who use e-wallet payment methods that have collaborated with CIS. In addition to attracting new users, this offer will make people more interested in using the CIS application.

2. Technology solutions for application stability and improved user experience

To improve the user experience, the CIS can add a guide or tutorial to explain the features in the CIS application, such as the "Tips" application on iPhone devices, which displays moving images and provides a brief tutorial on how to use the application or features in the application. This guide can be placed in any feature in the application, such as a pop-up, to make it easier for users to understand how a feature works.

In addition, CIS can use the microservices method to manage features in CIS applications that are managed separately but still integrated with each other, so it is possible to update existing features without affecting the performance of other features. The use of microservices architecture also aims to store CIS application user data entered by users during application registration and minimize system problems when users enter data. An example of the implementation of microservices architecture in the CIS application is updating customer data to overcome errors and loading problems when customers enter customer numbers. The CIS application can also add service features for meter removal and tank water purchase separately. Overall, the use of microservices in CIS applications can make the system more flexible and responsive to user needs, which can have an impact on customer satisfaction.

3. Additional features

In order to attract new users to the CIS application, PDAM Surabaya can add some innovative features. First, to increase user convenience in paying bills in the CIS application, payment methods available in the CIS application can be added, such as bank transfers or



virtual accounts, because according to existing data, almost 80-90% of users use bank accounts that are not available in the existing payment methods in the CIS application. For parents who are not familiar with using virtual accounts or bank transfers, CIS can provide a barcode scanning payment feature that can be used to pay at mini-markets such as Alfamart, Indomaret, etc. by showing the QR provided by the CIS application. In addition, CIS can add its own e-wallet feature to display balances in e-wallets that have collaborated with CIS (such as Tokopedia balances), as well as add other e-wallets such as Gopay, Ovo, etc.

Furthermore, the CIS application can add new services to pay bills for other household needs such as electricity bills which will certainly make it easier for people to fulfill their needs.

In addition, another feature that can help users is the meter conversion feature into the amount of price per number of meters to be paid, so that customers can estimate the amount of bills to be paid before using PDAM services. This will help customers save both financial and water expenses.

Conclusion

To increase brand awareness, CIS can use local influencers with soft selling methods, CIS can also offer discounts for new users and users who regularly pay water bills on time through the CIS application. CIS can collaborate with e-wallets and add promos for those who use the e-wallet payment method. Technology that can increase application stability and improve user experience is an application usage guide such as the “Tips” application on iPhone and microservices architecture that manages features separately but remains integrated with each other and makes it possible to update existing features without affecting the performance of other features and if there is a problem with one of the features, other features can continue to run normally. To attract the interest of Surabaya people, CIS can add new features such as adding payment methods through bank transfers, virtual accounts, and QR codes, adding services to pay electricity bills, and meter conversion features into prices.



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